

015. Chapter 2 Verses 41-44

Lectures by Swami Sarvapriyananda

VERSE 2.41

व्यवसायात्मिका बुद्धिरेकेह कुरुनन्दन ।
बहुशाखा ह्यनन्ताश्च बुद्धयोऽव्यवसायिनाम् ॥ 41 ॥

vyavasāyātmikā buddhir
ekeha kurunandana |
bahuśākhā hyanantāśca
buddhayo'vyavasāyinām ||

- ◆ **vyavasāyātmikā** – resolute; **buddhiḥ** – intellect;
- ◆ **ekā** – one/single; **iha** – here; **kuru-nandana** – O joy of the Kurus;
- ◆ **bahu-śākhāḥ** – many-branched; **hi** – indeed; **anantāḥ** – endless; **ca** – and;
- ◆ **buddhayaḥ** – thoughts/intelleccts; **avyavasāyinām** – of the irresolute.

O Arjuna! There is only one faith and thought for those who practice this Karma Yoga. The minds of others are divided into various branches, and their thoughts and speculations are endless.

O Arjuna! The unwise utter flowery speech, taking pleasure in the laudatory words of the Vedas, and say that there is nothing else but pleasures and enjoyments either here or in Heaven.

VERSE 2.43

कामात्मानः स्वर्गपरा जन्मकर्मफलप्रदाम् ।
क्रियाविशेषबहुलां भोगैश्वर्यगतिं प्रति ॥४३॥

kāmātmānaḥ svargaparā
janmakarmaphalapradām |
kriyāviśeṣabahulām
bhogaiśvaryagatiṁ prati ||

- ◆ **kāmātmānaḥ** – full of desires; **svarga-parāḥ** – regarding heaven as the highest goal;
- ◆ **janma-karma-phala-pradām** – leading to (new) birth as the reward of actions;
- ◆ **kriyā-viśeṣa-bahulām** – full of specific rituals;
- ◆ **bhoga-aiśvarya-gatim** – attainment of enjoyment and power; **prati** – towards.

They are full of desire, with heaven as their highest goal, leading to new births as the effect of their own Karma, and they engage themselves in a multiplicity of specific works for the purpose of acquiring enjoyments and prosperity.

VERSE 2.44

भोगैश्वर्यप्रसक्तानां तयापहृतचेतसाम् ।
व्यवसायात्मिका बुद्धिः समाधौ न विधीयते ॥ 44 ॥

bhogaiśvaryaprasaktānām
tayāpahṛtacetasām |
vyavasāyātmikā buddhiḥ
samādhau na vidhīyate ||

- ◆ **bhoga-aiśvarya-prasaktānām** – of those attached to pleasure and power;
- ◆ **tayā** – by that (flowery speech); **apahr̥ta-cetasām** – whose minds are drawn away;
- ◆ **vyavasāyātmikā** – resolute; **buddhiḥ** – intellect;
- ◆ **samādhau** – in the mind (or in meditation); **na** – not; **vidhīyate** – is formed.

The mind of such men who are drawn away by attachment to pleasure and wealth, cannot be concentrated to remain fixed in the ecstasy of divine contemplation.